

January

19



Also on this day

1817 To liberate Chile, Argentinian soldiers and Chilean patriots invaded the country by crossing the Andes mountains.

1981 The Algiers Accords ended the Iran hostage crisis, in which 52 US citizens were held hostage by Iran. The hostages returned home the next day.

1991 Invading Iraqi forces in Kuwait opened oil wells and pipelines, causing massive environmental damage.

1966

Indian icon

Indira Gandhi became the first female prime minister of India. She reduced India's reliance on other countries for food by increasing grain production. Gandhi served two terms before she was assassinated in 1984.



Zeppelin raid

1915

Germany used a Zeppelin L3 airship in a bombing mission for the first time. The attack on Great Yarmouth in England resulted in two deaths. Further Zeppelin raids killed about 500 people in the UK during World War I.

1986

Virus attack

An early computer virus, called BRAIN, was created by the Pakistani brothers Basit and Amjad Farooq Alvi to discourage software piracy.



Born this day

1839 Paul Cézanne, French artist. He produced more than 200 still-life paintings, 900 oil paintings, and 400 watercolours during four decades of work.

1946 Dolly Parton, US singer. She is celebrated for making country music popular and writing more than 3,000 songs.